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AFRICAN VISION MALAWI

CREATING LASTING CHANGE

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Our Vision: A healthy, educated, self-sufficient community in Malawi

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Malawi has a further 44% devaluation of the kwacha

On November 9th we all had a shock to hear that the Malawi Government had decided to devalue the kwacha by 44%. Last year they already devalued it by 25%. This was under pressure from the International Monetary Fund to extend additional credit to the country.

Overnight fuel prices doubled and are now the same as UK prices! The knock-on effect was for everyone to put up their prices of commodities. The people it will hit most are the poorest in Malawi. The subsistence farmers can't buy fertilisers which have doubled in price, basic market produce and utilities have doubled, school fees are increasing. We have heard our University fees will go from 450,000 to 1 million kwacha!

This will have a knock on effect to our organisation and we are giving our staff a 'hardship allowance' to help them through this difficult period. We are predicting starvation for many next year who are unable to grow food. Climate change is also affecting the growing season as we saw with Cyclone Freddy destroying crops last March. If you can consider supporting us on a monthly basis, it will really help to keep our important programmes going. You can donate at https://africanvisionmalawi.enthuse.com/#!/

SAM'S VILLAGE





Sam's Village is a purpose built eco training centre. All the buildings are earth built. We use the facility for life skills and vocational training. We held our half yearly LBC (**Local Based Committee**) meeting in September for 88 people. All the members are volunteers working within our community who support our programmes. They are key to our operation and for identifying and verifying beneficiaries.

Two training sessions were also held in October which were Simplifying Project Management and our Team Strategic Plan training. Both training sessions were facilitated by **Tony Williams** who has 40 years experience in training in the UK and Africa. All the participants enjoyed the interactive training and received certificates (photo below)

Tony's wife, Liz, also joined the visit and was kept busy volunteering around Sam's Village which included painting the room names in the Tree Block and helping sort our Special Needs resources. (photo right) The facility is open for training and if you would like to rent it out, please contact our office. We can cater for up to 50 people staying overnight and up to 100 visitors a day for training or conferences.











SUSTAINABLE AGRICULTURE

30 new beneficiaries of **Dimba gardens** (gardens by a riverbed) were trained in making organic compost. They are all people who support orphan and vulnerable children. We train them in organic growing and they use the food to feed their extended family. Surplus food can be sold to support their family's basic needs (photo top right)



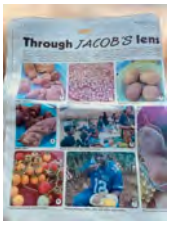
51 **Household permaculture gardens** were recently visited as part of our monitoring process. These are small gardens grown next to their household helping to provide food security. All these gardens are within 5km of Sam's Village to make monitoring more accessible. (photo right)

Chibwata, Chimbalu and Mundundu have **reforestation nurseries** growing 9,500 seedlings. A mix of acacia and fruit trees will be planted early next year in the rains. (photo right)



We have 83 beneficiary farmers around the Chitsime area who have been in the **Seed & Knowledge Initiative,** building up seed multiplication. This programme is through our partnership with **SCOPE Malawi** and has been very successful in providing food security. Our grateful thanks to SCOPE for their support. Our team and Chitsime community exhibited at S**ustainfest** which was held at the Civil Stadium grounds in Lilongwe in October. (photos below)









STAFF & VOLUNTEERS



We have three new staff who are on their probation at the moment. Firstly Grey Msiska joined us as Sam's Village Manager. Besides monitoring and maintaining the site, and enhancing it further, he is looking at renting out the space to other organizations who want to do training or conferences more affordable than in Lilongwe.

Our other new staff are Mphatso Tembo who is our Community Development Officer and Vitu Mhango who is our M&E Officer. Both are engaged in their new roles at AVM and making a positive difference.

Sadly Maggie Kaitano left us at the end of November. She was our Admin Officer and will be sadly missed. We wish her well in her new job.

In October we had 4 volunteers who came to support us. Carol Webb and Sian Pritchard were helping with our School Partnership programme which takes 3 weeks to complete. They did a fantastic job and we are so grateful for their support. Tony and Liz Williams joined us for a couple of weeks. Tony was facilitating the training at Sam's Village and Liz was volunteering. They were part of Project4Africa who funded the Maternity Unit and are very happy that we are enhancing this with the Safe Motherhood Unit.

Photos—Maggie Kaitano above, (bottom left to right)—Grey Msiska, Carol Webb, Mphatso Tembo, Sian Pritchard, Vitu Mhango, Liz and Tony Williams in the maternity unit.









EDUCATION







'Early Childhood Development (ECD) - We have 1,220 children registered in our 13 centres and we have now started to grow maize and soya gardens at 3 of the centres. Our grateful thanks to our donors who funded this so we can supply food to the feeding programmes. M'teza pre-school is having it's roof replaced after 10 years (photo above). Thanks to Katey's House pre-schools for funding to support this build which included toilets. Also thanks to all the knitters out there who donated their time and wool to knit lovely jumpers which we have distributed. (photo above centre).

School Partnerships - Our 20 partnership schools in Malawi were visited over a 3-week period in October by Carol Webb and Sian Pritchard. Our grateful thanks for their time in doing these important links. The themed link for both countries was on 'Weather & Climate Change'. St Pauls RC Primary School donated over 200 pencil cases (photo bottom right) which will be used to 'exchange' for 'eco-bricks' which are plastic bottles filled with single-use plastics. They will then be used to make seating areas. All schools were donated learning resources from their link schools, which included a blow up globe. (Photos below of the partnership links)

Scholarship programme— We currently have 7 Primary, 24 Secondary and 27 University students, with 13 Secondary who have finished and are waiting to apply to university, and 6 waiting to start university. Thanks to Gandy's International who donated jackets and rucksacks (photo above) to all of our students! Wezie Gwaluka (Education Manager) has just visited all our students around Malawi! If you would like to part-sponsor a student please get in touch with us.









HEALTH

Three of our Primary Schools benefitted from a Dental Outreach visit where they educate children about teeth hygiene and do on-the-job assessments and treatment. (photo bottom left) Emma Katengeza (Health Manager) was working with the Government dental technicians. Thanks to **Love Support United** for funding this annual programme. Emma also facilitates 10 Medical Outreach programmes each month and a Disability Outreach. (photo bottom right) So many children and adults struggle with different health issues and can't reach a clinic, so this programme is so important to reach and support the most vulnerable people. Each month we refer approximately 10 people with disabilities to appropriate organisations. Our grateful thanks go to **The Foundry International** and to **The London Prosthetic Centre** who are supporting our disability programmes. It is such a privilege to empower people to get independence in their lives and to see children going to school with their friends. It was wonderful to see a 12 year old double-amputee boy with prosthetics, actually playing football at M'khalapadzuwa School!

Our SEND (Special Educational Needs & Disability) phase one at M'bang'ombe Clinic will become a reality next year. This build is combined with our Safe Motherhood Unit (SMU) which will allow early identification and intervention for children with special needs. (photo second from left) is where the two buildings will be linked to form the new SMU.











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THANKS TO:
JAM TRUST
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THE LONDON PROSTHETIC CENTRE
OUR MALAWI TEAM
500 MILES
ALL SAINTS KNITTERS
TRUSTEES
GANDYS INTERNATIONAL FOUNDATION
ST MATTHEW'S CHURCH
CAROL WEBB
SIAN PRITCHARD
KINGSTON PROSTHETICS
PARTNERSHIP SCHOOLS
HEATHER CUMMINS
TONY & LIZ WILLIAMS
THE FOUNDRY INTERNATIONAL

500km Malawi cycle challenge - Pedal Power 10th - 20th May 2024



Our fundraisers are a key way of funding our programmes. Our last Pedal Power was very successful and we are doing a slightly different route in May 2024, which includes seeing cave paintings, riding **down** a 30km escarpment and feeding Fish Eagles on your day off, by the beautiful Lake Malawi. The safari is still included as a further day off. There are 6 cycle days and 2 days off interspersed, finishing at Sam's Village to have two days seeing our programmes and where your money goes!

We are doing a talk at **St Matthews Church, KT6 6JQ on Sunday 7th January** starting at 3:30pm. Refreshments, film, presentation and Q&A session. If you are interested, please come along or contact me for further information heather.palmer@africanvision.org.uk









FUNDRAISING EVENTS

Music for Malawi evening - We are holding an evening of music at **The cornerHOUSE Community Arts Centre,** 116 Douglas Road, KT6 7SB on Saturday **March 16th at 7:30pm**. Tickets are £16 and £13 for concessions.

Pedal Power - 10th to 20th May 2024 — (depart 9th May eve) 10 day trip. Cycle 500km over 6 days, 2 days off including a safari, and 2 days looking at our programmes. An experience of a lifetime not to be missed. £1,650 (includes local transport, accommodation, food, guide, bike hire, safari, visit cave paintings and backup support).

Recent events:

Indulgence Day—June 17th 2023

Our grateful thanks to all our therapists, volunteers and stall holders for making this yet again another successful fundraising event. We raised £2,300 on the day. Of course without the people attending this wouldn't be possible.

Partnership School Links— 2023

We are also very grateful to our School Partnership links. We have 24 links in UK with 22 schools in Malawi (including one pre-school). We have had some incredible fundraising happening in the UK.

St Paul's Catholic Primary, Thames Ditton raised £830; The Mall Primary School raised £303.60; St Paul's C of E Primary, Primrose Hill raised £443; St Matthew's C of E Primary, Surbiton raised £123.50; St John's C of E Primary, Kingston raised £343; Twickenham Prep School raised £3,201 to build a classroom; Knollmead Primary raised £105; Christ Church C of E Primary raised £504.43; Katey's House Nursery raised £518.31; Dysart Special School raised £103; Evergreen Special School raised £112; Coombe Hill Infants raised £93 ;and Briar Hill Infants School raised £350.

Totally amazing! Thanks for making a difference to your school in Malawi!

St Paul's Catholic Primary School, Thames Ditton also collected 280 full pencil cases for children in Malawi who are lucky to have a pencil, let alone a whole pencil case filled with pens and pencils!